

ALWAYS REDDY ATHLETICS

THE 5-DAY ATHLETIC RESET

FIVE DAYS. FIVE SESSIONS. 30-45 MINUTES EACH.

YOU USED TO BE AN ATHLETE. YOU STILL ARE –
YOU JUST NEED THE RIGHT SYSTEM TO PROVE IT.

alwaysreddyathletics.com

READ THIS FIRST

HOW THE RESET WORKS

This is not a fitness program. It's an identity test. Five days, five sessions, each one 30–45 minutes — short enough to fit around a full-time job, sharp enough to wake up the athlete that's been sitting in a desk chair.

Each day has one job. Day 1 restarts the engine. Day 2 rebuilds the movement patterns your sport used to give you for free. Day 3 undoes what the desk did to your hips. Day 4 puts a score on the board. Day 5 teaches you the skill nobody respects and everybody needs: recovering like an athlete.

THE RULES

Do the days in order.

The sequence is deliberate. Each session sets up the next.

Effort over ego.

Easy means easy. Hard means hard. Athletes know the difference — that's the whole skill.

Log everything.

Times, weights, reps, scores. Evidence is the point of the week. Write it in the log lines on each page.

Reply to the emails.

Each morning you'll get one email walking you through that day's session. Reply with your result — I read every one.

Miss a day? Don't restart.

Just do the next session the next day. Momentum beats perfection. Restarting is how comebacks die.

WHAT YOU NEED

A pair of running shoes, roughly 40 minutes a day, and either a set of dumbbells or nothing at all — every strength movement has a bodyweight version. No gym required to start. If you have one, even better.

COACH'S NOTE

One warning before Day 1: the biggest mistake former athletes make is training like it's still senior year on day one. That's how week-one injuries happen, and a week-one injury ends the comeback before it starts. This week, your only opponent is the version of you that quits by Wednesday. Beat him.

01

THE RUN THAT RESTARTS THE ENGINE

35-40 MIN

One easy run. Four strides. Evidence collected.

WARM-UP — 5 MIN

Brisk walk into light jog

5 min

Start walking, finish jogging. Let the body decide when it's ready to run.

THE SESSION

Easy conversational run

20-25 min

The pace test: you should be able to speak in full sentences the entire time. If you can't, slow down. Yes, slower than that. Ego pace is how comebacks end in week one.

Haven't run in 6+ months? Run/walk instead

25 min

Alternate 3 minutes of easy running with 1 minute of walking. This is the smarter start, not the weaker one.

THE PART THAT MATTERS — STRIDES

Strides — relaxed, fast, tall posture

4 × 20 sec

After the run, on flat ground: accelerate smoothly to about 85% of your top speed, hold it 20 seconds, coast to a stop. Walk 60-90 seconds between each. This is where you'll feel it — the turnover, the pop, the thing you remember.

Cool-down walk

3-5 min

COACH'S NOTE

The goal today isn't fitness — nobody builds fitness in one run. The goal is evidence. You're proving the operating system still boots. The strides are the point of the whole session: 80 total seconds of feeling like an athlete again. Don't skip them.

LOG IT:

Total time / distance / how the strides felt (one word is fine)

02

LIFT LIKE AN ATHLETE

40-45 MIN

Movements, not muscles. Hinge, squat, push, pull, carry.

WARM-UP — 6 MIN

Jumping jacks bodyweight squats arm circles

2 rounds

30 seconds each, no rest. You should be warm, not tired.

THE SESSION — REST 60-90 SEC BETWEEN SETS

1. Goblet Squat (or bodyweight squat, 3×15)

3 × 10

Hold a dumbbell at your chest. Sit between your hips, chest tall. Depth you can own beats depth you can't.

2. Dumbbell Romanian Deadlift (or hip hinge + glute bridge, 3×15)

3 × 10

Soft knees, push the hips back, flat back. You should feel the hamstrings load like a spring.

3. Push-Up

3 × 8-12

Full range, body in one line. Elevate hands on a bench if needed — that's scaling, not cheating.

4. One-Arm Dumbbell Row (or backpack row)

3 × 10 / side

Pull the elbow to the hip, not the hand to the shoulder. Squeeze at the top. Desk posture dies here.

5. Farmer Carry (heaviest thing you can hold with good posture)

3 × 40 steps

Walk tall, shoulders down, grip crushing. The most athletic exercise nobody does.

6. Finisher: Plank

2 × 45 sec

Squeeze everything. Long line from head to heels.

COACH'S NOTE

Every movement here is a pattern your sport used to train for free. The weights will feel lighter than your ego wants — good. We're laying a foundation, and foundations don't need to be maxed. They need to be laid. Move every rep like it belongs to someone who used to compete. Because it does.

LOG IT:

Weights used / anything that felt rusty (that's your Day 3 target list)

03

UNDO THE DESK

30 MIN

A 30-minute mobility flow for hips, ankles, and spine.

Two thousand hours a year in a chair changes a body. Your hips shorten, your ankles stiffen, your upper back rounds forward to meet a screen. Most comeback attempts don't die from lack of fitness — they die from moving like a desk. Today we start reversing it.

THE FLOW — 2 ROUNDS, SLOW IS THE SKILL

1. 90/90 Hip Switches

10 / side

Sit tall, rotate the knees side to side. Control, not momentum.

2. World's Greatest Stretch

5 / side

Deep lunge, elbow toward the floor, then rotate and reach for the ceiling. It earned the name.

3. Couch Stretch

60 sec / side

Rear foot up a wall or couch, squeeze the glute, stay tall. This is the anti-chair. It will not be comfortable. That's the data.

4. Ankle Rocks

12 / side

Half-kneeling, drive the front knee over the toes, heel glued down. Stiff ankles steal your stride.

5. Open Books

8 / side

Side-lying, top arm sweeps open, follow the hand with your eyes. Breathe into the twist. Your thoracic spine will thank you audibly.

6. Deep Squat Hold

60 sec

Heels down, chest tall, elbows pry the knees out. Hold something for balance if needed. You lived here as a kid.

7. Hamstring Floss

10 / side

On your back, hug one thigh, slowly straighten and bend the knee. Tension, not pain.

8. Dead Hang (optional, if you have a bar)

2 × 30 sec

Grip the bar, relax everything below the hands. Decompression for the whole system.

COACH'S NOTE

Do this barefoot if you can, and move at half the speed that feels natural — slow is the skill. This flow takes less time than a lunch meeting and it's the highest-leverage 30 minutes of your week. It's also the session that keeps Days 1, 2, and 4 sustainable past the point where most comebacks quit.

LOG IT:

Tightest area found today — that's the one you hit twice next week

04

THE BASELINE

35-40 MIN

You miss competing. Today you get a scoreboard back.

Be honest — it's not the fitness you miss most. It's the scoreboard. The clock, the gun, the moment where effort gets measured and there's nowhere to hide. Today we bring it back. This is a three-part test. The score you set today is the number future-you spends the next months hunting down.

WARM-UP — 10 MIN, DO NOT SKIP

Easy jog + 2 relaxed strides + Day 3 moves #1 and #4

10 min

You cannot test cold. A real warm-up is the difference between a baseline and an injury.

THE TEST

PART 1 — One Mile, For Time

ALL OUT (SMART)

Track, flat road, or treadmill. Pace it like an athlete: controlled first half, fight the second. Note the time to the second.

Rest / walk

5 min

PART 2 — Max Push-Ups

2 min

Strict form only — chest to within a fist of the floor, full lockup. Rest in plank or downdog, but the clock runs. Count total reps.

Rest

2 min

PART 3 — Max Air Squats

2 min

Hips below parallel, full stand. Same rules: rest standing, clock runs. Count total reps.

YOUR BASELINE

MILE: _____ PUSH-UPS: _____ SQUATS: _____ DATE: _____

COACH'S NOTE

You're not being graded against anyone else. You're setting the number your future self is going to break — and re-testing a baseline you set yourself is the single most addictive part of getting your athlete back. Give it a real effort, not a jog-through. Then reply to today's email with your three numbers. I want to see them.

05

THE REST-DAY PROTOCOL

30-40 MIN

Recovery is a skill. Today you train it.

Here's what separates athletes from people who work out: athletes treat recovery as training. You put three hard days and a test into your legs this week. Today isn't a day off — it's the session that lets you absorb all of it.

THE PROTOCOL

1. Walk — outside, no phone, no podcast

20-30 min

Blood flow for the legs, silence for the head. The no-phone rule is not negotiable. Some of your best thinking about what comes next happens here.

2. Foam Roll (or lacrosse ball / massage gun)

10 min

Quads, hamstrings, glutes, calves, upper back. Slow passes, breathe through the tender spots.

3. Box Breathing

5 min

Inhale 4 sec, hold 4, exhale 4, hold 4. Repeat. This flips the nervous system from stress to recovery — the same switch you'll want the night before every race and big meeting for the rest of your life.

4. Hydration + Fuel

ALL DAY

Water with a pinch of salt through the day. A real protein-anchored dinner. Recovery is built in the kitchen more than the foam roller.

5. Sleep

8 HR TARGET

In bed 30 minutes earlier than normal, screens down. Sleep is the only supplement with unlimited proof behind it.

THE DEBRIEF — 3 QUESTIONS, PEN AND PAPER

1. When did you feel most like an athlete this week — which exact moment?
2. What's your Day 4 baseline, and what do you want those numbers to be in 12 weeks?
3. What broke every previous comeback attempt — and what system would have to exist for this one to be different?

COACH'S NOTE

Question 3 is the real one. Motivation is weather — it was always going to fade. The comebacks that stick are the ones with a season, a schedule, and a scoreboard built around them. You just ran a five-day season. Tomorrow's email is about what the ones who keep going do next.

YOU FINISHED THE RESET

THE SPARK FADES. THE SYSTEM CARRIES YOU.

Five days ago you were a guy with a desk job who used to be an athlete. This week you ran with intent, lifted like an athlete, undid some of the chair damage, and put a real score on the board. That's not a fitness week — that's an identity week.

Most people finish something like this, feel great, and drift. Not because they're lazy — because they had a spark and no system.

The Rebuild Club is the system: structured training on a Speed track and an Endurance track, the weekly mobility work from Day 3, challenges and a leaderboard built around your Day 4 baseline, and a community of former athletes rebuilding on the same schedule — with me coaching inside it.

JOIN THE REBUILD CLUB

Founding rate locked for life · alwaysreddyathletics.com

ALWAYS REDDY ATHLETICS